# Before you leave the hospital

Leave with your prescriptions, a care plan, and the name and number of someone to call.

- [ ] Make four lists from the discharge summary: medicines to take, with dose and timing; medicines to stop; follow-up visits and tests, with who sets up each one; and the warning signs that mean coming back. **prompt-discharge.txt**
- [ ] If anything on those lists is unclear or contradicts something else you were told, ask before you go.
- [ ] Medicare inpatient, and sure it's too soon? Call the quality-improvement organization listed on your Important Message from Medicare, on the day of discharge at the latest. A phone request counts. Then confirm it in writing. **discharge-appeal.txt**
- [ ] If you ask for that review in time, you owe nothing for the extra days while it's pending, apart from your usual cost sharing.
- [ ] Once you're home, message your primary-care doctor through the portal about the stay, and ask whether they need to see you. **prompt-primary-care.txt**
- [ ] Ask for your records: the discharge summary now, and the full chart, which the hospital has thirty days to send. **records.txt**
- [ ] When the bill for the stay arrives, start with the checklist Before you pay a hospital bill.

**General information about how health care works, not medical or legal advice. Nothing here should delay care in an emergency. The letters named here are free at healthusersguide.com.**